Happenings in Handmade

A CCI initiative

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KANSA: A HAND HAMMERED HERITAGE



Have you ever eaten off a Kansa plate? If not, you're missing out on one of India’s most timeless crafts, a gorgeous blend of utility, wellness, and heritage!





Kansa, or bell-metal, is a mix of copper and tin (approximately 80:20), known not just for its rich glow but also for being Ayurveda approved. It’s believed to aid digestion, purify food, and balance your doshas. But the magic lies in how it’s made and where. Let’s take a tour, shall we?

In West Bengal, kansa artisans (called kansaris) heat and beat metal into elegant vessels and melodious singing bowls. They are famous for making hand hammered textures and classic utility ware.











In Assam, you'll find the town of Sarthebari, where artisans craft kansa bata and banbati, ritual bowls used in almost every Assamese puja. The process? Hammer, polish with tamarind, and shine!











In Odisha, villages like Balakati are buzzing with kansa workshops. Here, entire families work together. One heats, one hammers, one scrapes to a shine, making vessels traditionally gifted at weddings.











In Kerala, the Mannar region is known for bell-metal utensils. Urulis are made by sand casting in a clay mould and then chiselled and polished to perfection. These wide, shallow and heavy bowls are perfect for slow-cooked festive sweets.



But sadly, this craft is fading. Steel, teflon and plastic are pushing these artisanal treasures into the shadows.



So the next time you see a kansa vessel, pause, touch it. Maybe even take it home and let it whisper its tale of artistry and culture.



CREDITS

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